

Gourevitch 1978 RG Notes

Gourevitch, Peter. "The Second Image Reversed: The International Sources of Domestic Politics" [1978].

International Organization 32(4): 881-912.

Basic argument: domestic political institutions may be largely shaped by international politics and systems. Expands previous theories focusing primarily as IR as a consequence of domestic politics, rather than a cause

"Instead of being a cause of international politics, domestic structure may be a consequence of it. International systems, too, become causes instead of consequences" (Gourevitch, 1978, p. 882)

Two primary forces of IR on domestic politics: distribution of power among states (war), and distribution of economic activity (trade)

Dahl 1972 discusses conquest as a cause of internal structure, which is basically the "simple" theory that Gourevitch is expanding on.

"The very configuration which made it possible for Germany and Japan, and to a lesser extent Italy, to catch up to Britain so rapidly (the survival of classes, institutions, and values from a preindustrial, anticonstitutionalist era), also made those countries more vulnerable to fascism." (Gourevitch, 1978, p. 886)